

to keep abreast of important developments as they arose. Presidents Abraham Lincoln and Jefferson Davis both used the telegraph extensively to keep in close communication with the commanders of their principal field armies, and their commanders, in turn, developed ciphers and codes to transmit and receive messages in secret. Both sides developed wiretapping and code-cracking capabilities during the war, but the information gleaned from these methods rarely created decisive military results. In October 1861, the Lincoln administration established the U.S. Military Telegraph Service (U.S.M.T.S).